

investment as you can do up the place to add value, and you're more in control of the asset as you can decide on rent, who your tenants are and any changes you want to make. One of the biggest benefits of property investing is that you can also use it as leverage: you're borrowing money from the bank via a mortgage, but the increases in the property price of your home you get to keep. The truth is the stock market often outperforms how fast property prices rise, but that thing called leverage is why many people look into property.

Real estate is not a bad form of investing, but it's not the most accessible form of investing for the average investor. The risks involved in real estate and stock market investing vary, but in the same way that you can purchase bad stocks and lose out, you can also do so with bad homes.

There are many myths that surround stock market investing, and I'm never upset at any of them. It's human nature to protect ourselves from the unknown, and in this context that protection can look like statements that suggest investing is like gambling, or that it's too risky. The truth is that once the information is laid out clearly it's very easy to cut through the noise and realise investing is an accessible and frankly wonderful wealth generator for investors in training to use.

Actionable steps

1. If someone has told you that they lost a lot of money on the stock market, ask if they could explain further so you can learn what led to it.
2. Circle the investing myths you used to believe. How many of them did you have out of 5?
3. If real estate and the stock market had similar levels of risk, would you prefer one over the other?